

## Apple, Compaq or IBM?

**Q** I need a laptop for high-end multimedia applications such as Autocad, CorelDraw, and a few other processor-intensive programs. I like the Apple PowerBook (15"), but my friends say that the Compaq B8000 series and IBM R series are equally good. I don't want the laptop to be too heavy, and my budget is Rs 1.1 lakh. Which one would you suggest?

Vinay Anand

**001** I suggest you to go for a Windows-based system for the wide array of software available. As far as processing power goes, Apple's PowerBook and Windows-based laptops are pretty much neck-to-neck. However, when it comes to application support, Mac OS isn't quite popular with software developers and hence, very few professional applications are available for Mac OSes. The R-series from IBM is good.

Also, opt for a Centrino-platform laptop over a Pentium 4-based laptop, simply for the performance and better battery life offered by the Centrino platform.

## Mobile Mania

**Q** I want to buy a mobile phone; it should have Bluetooth, a camera with at least 10 minutes of recording (preferably with Night Shot), FM, MP3, a good screen, and four hours of talk time, and it must look great! I have a budget of around Rs 15k.

Jishad

**001** First, I would ask you to look at the K700i from Sony Ericsson. An upgraded version of the K700i, to be called K750i, is on the horizon. It has a 2-megapixel camera and support for a memory stick, which the K700i lacks. You can also look out for the Nokia 6600, but the video recording is limited to just 10 seconds. The Nokia 6230, despite having most of the features you asked for, doesn't have a large screen.

## More On Mobiles

**Q** Is there a mobile phone with Bluetooth, add-on memory capability, and an easy programmable interface (J2ME), but without a camera?

Raja Sekar

**001** Almost all smart phones from Sony Ericsson and Nokia are J2ME-capable. However, it is difficult to point out a particular phone that does not have a camera and still has memory upgradeability.

At the same time, older J2ME phones with no camera have very little memory onboard—around 700-odd KB, which is not good for any programming that you may be interested in.

## Of Thumb Drives

**Q** I want to buy a 128 MB thumb drive for under Rs 1,500. I want to transfer data files smaller

As far as processing power goes, Apple's PowerBook and Windows-based laptops are pretty much neck-to-neck

than 100 MB from my college computer to my home PC. A plug-and-play drive would be preferable.

Rajiv Bhalotia

**001** You can buy a Transcend Thumb drive for around Rs 1,500. Contact Mediaman Infotech on 022-23828100. Also, almost all pen-drives are plug-and-play devices. If your PC has Windows 98 or ME, you will need to install the drivers, otherwise it will be automatically detected and initialised for use by Windows XP.

## DVD/Combo Writer Please!

**Q** I want to buy a DVD/Combo writer for backing up my data. Could you suggest a good one? I need a drive with 52X writing speed and 16X DVD writing speed.

Dr V K Saxena

**001** Typically, a combo drive costs between Rs 2,500 and Rs 2,950 depending on the brand. You can go for Lite-On, Sony, Asus or BenQ. In case of DVD-writers, buy them if your data set is going to be larger—that is, above 1 GB. You can buy a 16X DVD-Writer too, but as of right now, DVD media availability is an issue. For your information, DVD-writers will cost upwards of Rs 4.5k.

**001** Month after month, I keep getting letters asking for a high-end, low-end and a mid-range PC configuration. I've decided to answer them all at once (see adjoining box).

I am addressing the low and mid-range configurations. In case of a high-end PC, just change the processor and graphics card in the mid-range PC to the fastest and the best available! You can even increase the memory to 1 GB, if you please.

### Choose Your Computer

| High-End                 | Make                           | Cost (Rs)     |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------|
| CPU                      | 3200+                          | 7,500         |
| Motherboard              | MSI RS480M2                    | 6,500         |
| RAM                      | 512 MB DDR 400 Hynix           | 3,500         |
| HDD                      | 80 GB SATA Samsung/Seagate     | 2,650         |
| Monitor                  | 17" Acer 715                   | 6,500         |
| Keyboard                 | Logitech                       | 300           |
| Mouse                    | Logitech Optical Mouse         | 300           |
| Cabinet                  | Any cabinet you like           | 500           |
| Power supply             | Antec / VIP 350 W power supply | 2,000         |
| Optical Drive            | Lite on / Sony Combo drive     | 2,750         |
| Speakers                 | Creative Inspire 2.1           | 2,400         |
| <b>Total</b>             |                                | <b>34,900</b> |
| Graphics Card (optional) | XFX Geforce 6600 card          | 12,000        |
| Low-End                  |                                |               |
| CPU                      | AMD Sempron 2500+              | 3500          |
| Motherboard              | ASUS A7N8X-VM                  | 4500          |
| RAM                      | 256 MB DDR 400 Hynix           | 1600          |
| HDD                      | 80 GB SATA Samsung/Seagate     | 2650          |
| Monitor                  | 15" Acer 715                   | 4500          |
| Keyboard                 | Logitech                       | 300           |
| Mouse                    | Logitech Optical Mouse         | 300           |
| Cabinet                  | Any cabinet you like           | 500           |
| Power supply             | Antec / VIP 350 W power supply | 2000          |
| Optical Drive            | Sony CD-Rom                    | 700           |
| Speakers                 | Creative SB15                  | 450           |
| <b>Total</b>             |                                | <b>21,000</b> |

### Ask Away

Want a tech product, but don't know how to go about buying it? Send an e-mail to agent001@thinkdigit.com to get your queries answered